



Tinotenda M Madzunguruse, Wine Steward

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PROFILE

Results-driven Sommelier with over 5 years of experience in luxury hospitality environments. Adept at curating wine lists, conducting engaging tastings, and providing expert wine pairings to enhance customer satisfaction and drive sales growth. Passionate about wine education and dedicated to delivering exceptional service.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Sommelier, Bartinney Private Cellar

Aug 2024 — Present

- Conduct in-depth wine tastings, sharing insights about Bartinney's award-winning wines, the winemaking process, and the estate's heritage to enhance guest experiences.
- Actively promote Bartinney's portfolio by tailoring recommendations to guest preferences, contributing to increased customer satisfaction and repeat purchases.
- Collaborate with the sales and marketing team to implement engaging strategies for on-site and online promotions that boost visibility and sales.
- Manage and organize private events, including wine-pairing dinners and exclusive cellar tours, ensuring guests receive a seamless and memorable experience.
- Train junior staff on wine service techniques, product knowledge, and customer engagement to uphold Bartinney's high service standards.
- Oversee stock control to ensure the tasting room remains well-prepared for daily operations and special events.

Sommelier, MERTIA

Dec 2023 — Jul 2024

- Implement a system to manage inventory and control stock levels for all beverages served in the restaurant.
- Elevated the restaurant's wine list through strategic development and continuous enhancement.
- Conducted impactful food and wine pairings, enhancing guests' dining experiences.
- Demonstrated leadership in allocating dining locations and optimizing wine sales.
- I prioritized a customer-first approach, ensuring active sales promotion focusing on guest satisfaction.
- Developed a wine education program for staff that increased their knowledge of wines and improved their ability to recommend wines to customers
- Created a wine pairing menu that showcased the unique characteristics of each wine and its ability to complement the flavors of food

Sommelier, Constantia Uitsig

Jun 2023 — Nov 2024, Cape Town

- Led seamless inventory management for the farm's tasting room and 5 restaurants.

SKILLS

Wine Expertise: Extensive knowledge of wine regions, grape varieties, production methods, and tasting techniques.

Food and Wine Pairing: Proficient in creating and recommending complementary wine pairings to enhance dining experiences.

Customer Service Excellence: Skilled in delivering exceptional service to guests, building rapport, and fostering loyalty

Wine Sales and Upselling: Experienced in promoting wine lists, premium bottles, and packages to achieve and exceed sales targets.

Inventory Management: Skilled in maintaining and managing stock levels to ensure operational efficiency.

Communication and Storytelling: Capable of engaging guests with compelling stories about wines, their origins, and production methods.

LANGUAGES

English

- Fostered loyalty and growth through exceptional service and curated tastings.
- Optimized staff scheduling for peak performance.
- Expertly handled customer relations, enhancing reputation and loyalty.
- Managed the wine club, engaging and supporting farm guests and customers.
- Implemented a points-based strategy program that significantly increased wine club sign-ups.

Wine Steward, Muratie Wine Estate

Dec 2019 — May 2023

- Drove a remarkable 25% increase in wine club sign-ups since joining the tasting room team.
- Successfully improved the buying rate ratio per visitor in the tasting room, resulting in increased sales and revenue.
- Utilized effective sales techniques and persuasive communication skills to encourage guests to make purchases.
- Implemented strategic up-selling and cross-selling strategies to maximize the value of each customer transaction.

EDUCATION

Cape Wine Academy, Certificate in Wine

Oct 2021, Stellenbosch

Wine and Spirit Educational Trust (WSET), Level 2

Oct 2021

DOCUMENTS

C1/D VISA

Dec 2024 — Nov 2026

Seafarer's Medical Certificate

Oct 2024 — Oct 2026

Seaman's Book

Oct 2024 — Oct 2034

Bermuda ID

Oct 2024 — Oct 2029